

among the large banks where we have launched project 'Thrive' with a focus on internal careers. Since we launched it in April 2023, almost 4,500 employees have moved jobs through our internal talent marketplace, and 25% of them [have been] promoted," says Vempati.

The bank's numerous initiatives aimed at fostering an enriching work-life experience have earned it a top spot in the BT-Taggd survey of The Best Companies to Work For in India this year.

Axis Bank further reinforced its commitment to equal opportunities through proactive diversity, equity, and inclusion (DE&I) programmes. Initiatives such as 'HouseWorkIsWork', 'ComeAsYouAre', and the 'Pride365 Employee

Resource Group' challenge traditional biases, embrace a pluralistic workforce, and foster an innovative culture.

"In 2021, Axis Bank announced its initiative 'ComeAsYouAre'—a charter of policies and practices for employees and customers from the LGBTQIA+ community. It listed several initiatives that the bank undertook to embrace diversity, equity, and inclusion. Our comprehensive policies and practices for the LGBTQIA+ community include covering gender-affirming surgeries, extending mediclaim benefits to partners regardless of gender, allowing nominations of partners and joint accounts irrespective of gender, sexuality, or marital status, adopting 'Mx' as a [gender neutral]

honorific," says Vempati.

Promoting gender equity, women comprise 25% of its 104,333-strong workforce, with Axis Bank aiming for 30% diversity in the near future. Performance metrics are driven by balanced scorecards, with more than 70% of employees in templated roles, where KRAs and deliveries are reported directly from the system.

Vempati adds that the bank ensures there is proper mentoring across all levels. "Our talent and performance philosophy is differentiated by a culture of conversations. The MD & CEO personally meets every department head across the bank twice a year for a development-focussed conversation, and we have vibrant discussions in our management committee about what our talent pipeline is and the needs of the organisation twice a year," she says. This is supported by a strong mentoring programme which has grown over three years—from 50 to 250 mentees, Vempati adds.

For its employees to thrive, the bank ensures a listening framework, wellness programmes, and learning journeys to make a difference for people in their careers and allow them to develop skills. "The ability to shape careers at the intersection of innovation, digital, technology and customer experience truly offers our people the chance to craft interesting and challenging careers. And our position as a challenger bank allows individuals to take on large responsibilities with a variety of learning experiences within a single role, because we are pushing for transformation in every business and function," says Vempati. **BT**

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Key HR initiatives

▶ Empowering careers through 'Thrive' initiative for internal recruitment and promotions

▶ Embracing flexible work with 'GIG-A-Opportunities' offering full-time virtual and freelancer roles to broaden talent pool

▶ Cultivating talent through MD & CEO-led development conversations and mentoring programmes

▶ Building talent pipeline via campus programmes like 'Arise,' opening manage-

ment trainee roles to students nationwide

▶ Initiatives like 'HouseWorkIs-Work', 'ComeAsYouAre', and the 'Pride365 Employee Resource Group' challenge set biases